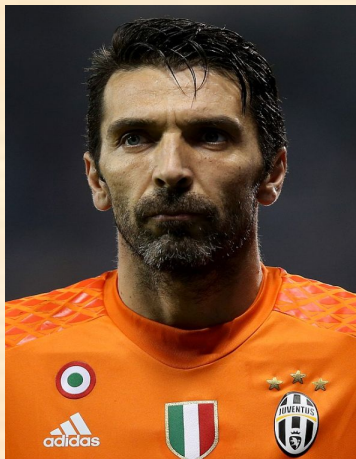

EUROPEAN FOOTBALL: DOES A GOALKEEPER HEIGHT MATTER?



EXAMPLES OF GREAT GOALKEEPERS

BUFFON: 1.93 m



COURTOIS: 1.98 m



NEUER: 1.93 m



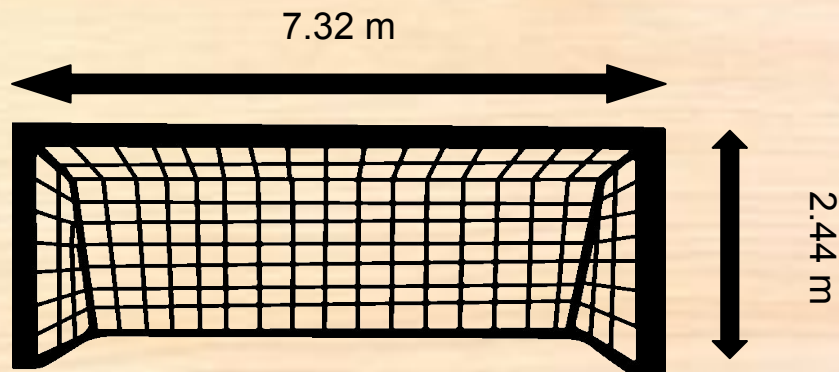
Average height of men in Europe: 1.76 - 1.80 m (source : [donneesmondiales.com](https://www.donneesmondiales.com))

SOME DATA ABOUT GOALKEEPERS

Goalkeeper's metrics:

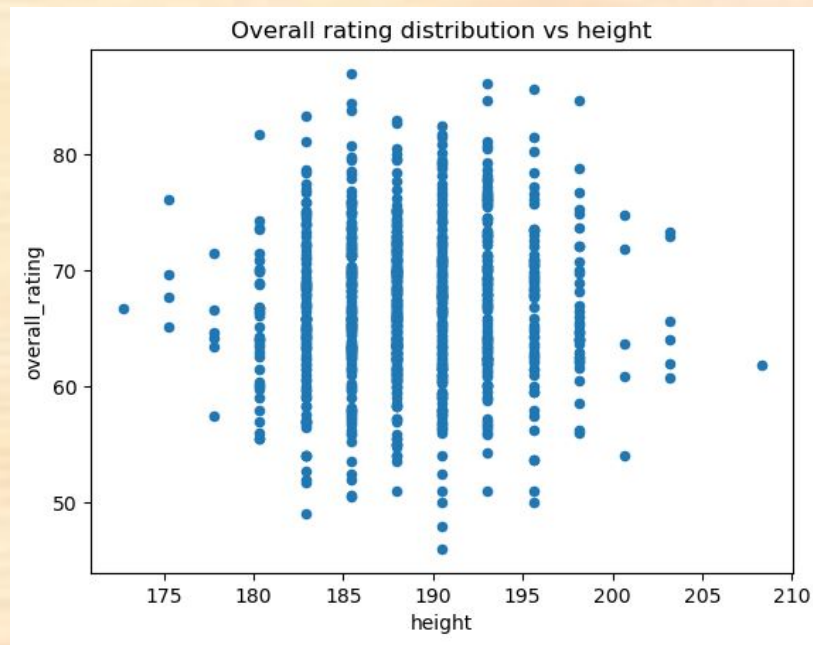
- ⚽ Height
- ⚽ Reflexes
- ⚽ Positioning
- ⚽ Weight
- ⚽ Agility
- ⚽ ...

Size of a football cage:



DATA ANALYSIS - EDA

- ⚽ No relationship between a goalkeeper's height and his overall rating.
- ⚽ Goalkeeper's average height is 1.88 m, and the distribution around this value is very homogeneous.
- ⚽ 95% of goalkeepers have a height between 1.78 m and 1.98 m.

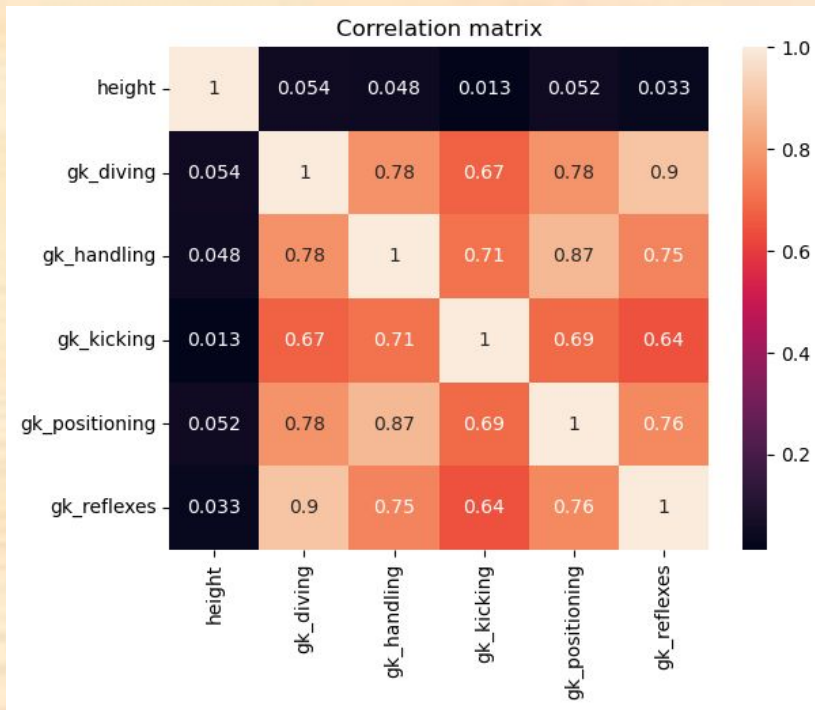


DATA ANALYSIS - FEATURES

Chosen features:

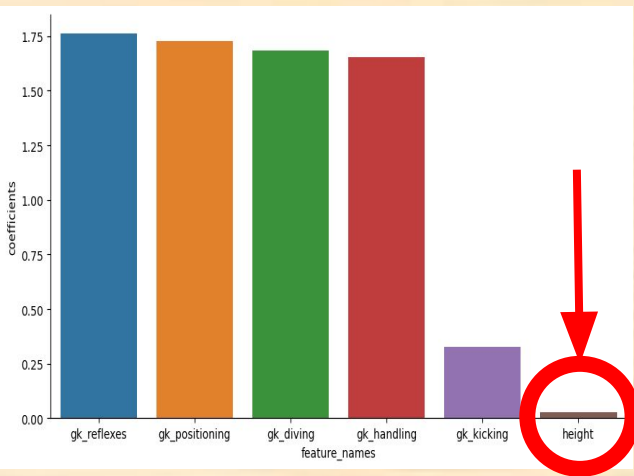
-  Height of the goalkeeper
-  Diving skills
-  Handling skills
-  Kicking skills
-  Reflexes
-  Positioning skills

Some of the features are **mathematically correlated**, but **they are independent in real life**.



DATA ANALYSIS - FEATURE WEIGHTS IN OVERALL RATING

Model 1



Model 2



Model 3



DATA ANALYSIS - FEATURE WEIGHTS IN OVERALL RATING



R^2 train: 0.9931

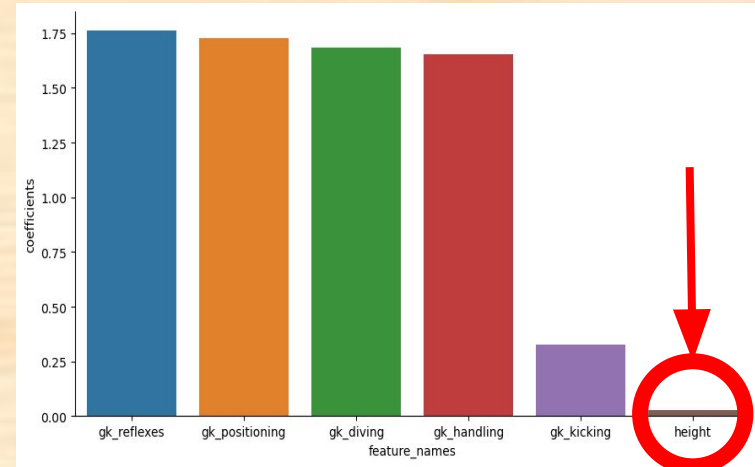


R^2 test: 0.9927



Importance of **technical skills** over height

Feature importance in overall rating



TECHNICAL SKILLS MATTER (MUCH) MORE THAN HEIGHT

VALDES: 1.83 m



Rating: 83
Ranking: 8th

CASILLAS: 1.85 m



Rating: 87
Ranking: 1st

JULIO CESAR: 1.85 m



Rating: 84
Ranking: 7th

THANKS FOR WATCHING !

